

Maria Kowalski

Senior Backend Software Engineer

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SUMMARY

Backend engineer with 8 years of experience designing high-throughput distributed systems for the fintech sector. Specializes in Go and Python microservices, event-driven architecture, and reducing infrastructure cost at scale. Led the redesign of a core payments ledger that now processes over 40 million transactions a day.

CORE SKILLS

Languages	Go, Python, Java, SQL
Infrastructure	Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, AWS (EKS, RDS, SQS, Lambda)
Data & Messaging	PostgreSQL, Redis, Kafka, gRPC
Practices	Distributed systems design, CI/CD, on-call/observability, TDD

EXPERIENCE

Senior Backend Software Engineer

Mar 2022 - Present

Northbridge Payments — Chicago, IL

- Redesigned the core transaction ledger service from a monolith into 6 Go microservices, cutting p99 latency from 850ms to 120ms while sustaining 40M+ daily transactions.
- Introduced an event-sourcing pattern with Kafka for the settlement pipeline, eliminating a class of reconciliation bugs that had caused roughly \$2M in manual correction work annually.
- Led capacity planning and a multi-region failover redesign on AWS, reducing unplanned downtime by 92% year over year.
- Mentored 4 mid-level engineers and built the team's onboarding curriculum, cutting new-hire ramp time from 10 weeks to 4.

Backend Software Engineer

Jul 2018 - Feb 2022

Fenwick Analytics — Chicago, IL

- Built and shipped a Python/Django billing API used by over 300 enterprise clients, integrating with Stripe and internal ledgering systems.
- Migrated a legacy batch reporting pipeline to a streaming architecture using Kafka and Flink, reducing report generation time from 6 hours to 11 minutes.
- Owned the on-call rotation for the payments platform; authored runbooks and alerting rules that cut mean-time-to-resolution by 45%.

Software Engineer

Jun 2016 - Jun 2018

Lakeview Software Studio — Chicago, IL

- Developed REST APIs and internal tooling in Java and Python for a portfolio of small-business SaaS products.
- Wrote the test automation suite that raised backend code coverage from 38% to 81%.

EDUCATION

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign

2012 - 2016

B.S. in Computer Science

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Professional
- Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA)